

Judgment, Revelation, and the Authority God Needs in the Earth

Why don't you go ahead and open up to the book of Acts. Hallelujah.

Well, why don't we begin with about - I am way over here in chapter 13, but that is not where I want to be. How about the fifth chapter again?

I have edited this entry a little bit more, and I am going to practice it on you just because I feel like it. Hallelujah. Sometimes I like to read it out loud so I can hear what it sounds like.

We have a real complicated subject. I mean complicated: a judgment so severe and final, Ananias and Sapphira. When you have a subject like this that nobody seems to have a doctrine on that can agree with the entire Word of God, how do you approach something like that? How do you introduce it? How do you make transitions from one total thought to another and leave people in a condition where they do not have to wrestle to understand the change?

All of that has to do with writing, assimilation, and meditation.

Anyway, these are my rough copies when I get them. This is not very many yet. I am still entering. Are you ready?

Before we get into this, some of the things we are breaking open are pretty complicated. I want to remind you what Paul said. He was given a glimpse both in his public ministry, but he also gave us a rare look into his private life.

He said, "In church I would rather speak five words in a language you would understand than ten thousand words in an unknown tongue."

What he was really saying there is, "I would rather spend the ten thousand words at home in the unknown tongue so you would understand what I understand in the five words I communicate to you, which I got from praying in the Holy Spirit."

For he that prays in an unknown tongue speaks not unto men but unto God. Howbeit, analytically, in the Spirit this man is speaking mysteries.

Well, they are not mysteries for God's sake. There is nothing He needs to know that He does not already know. Which one of you is going to illuminate Him?

So I am speaking mysteries for whose benefit? Like any other kind of praying, it is designed to be answered. The mysteries you are speaking are the mystery of everything Christ is in you, to you, and through you: the hope of glory. It is a revelation gift, because His whole plan personally for you is in that language too.

He that searches the hearts knows what is the mind, the plan of God for this season of your life, and enables Him to make intercession for you according to the will of God. Then we can know that all things work together for good to them that love God and are called according to His purpose.

Thank You, Jesus.

So Paul gave a glimpse into his private life. He said, "I thank my God that I pray more in the tongue that encompasses the understanding of the mysteries of God than all of you." And he was responsible for three quarters of the major revelation knowledge in the New Testament, the hard part. He was even called to help the other apostles out, though he was born out of due season.

Think about it. These great men went ahead and captured what they laid out in the canon of Scripture. You pick these books up, and some of them are addressing problems that had already arisen in the church. Some of them, like Romans, are a masterpiece. An absolute masterpiece.

Paul was the author of most of them because he understood them. They are writing down these mysteries, and it seems like the analytical mind is not enough to get into them.

Most people think Romans 7 is a believer having trouble with his flesh. We do not need Romans 7 to tell us that. Romans 7 is not a believer having trouble with his flesh. In fact, if you do not understand Romans 7, you might as well throw Romans 8 out.

When he said, "There is therefore now," that "now" made reference back to Romans 7:

There is therefore now no condemnation to them which are in Christ Jesus, who walk not after the flesh, but after the Spirit.

What kind of condemnation was he talking about? Go back to Romans 7 and find out.

Hypothetically speaking, Paul put himself in the place of every Jew. He said:

The good that I would do, I cannot seem to do it. And the evil I was trying not to do, I keep ending up doing it. So it is no longer I that do it, but sin that dwelleth in me.

People say, "See, you cannot get free."

Yes, you can.

He was talking about the spiritually dead Jew who received the law and could not keep it, and the state that put him in. "The good I would do, I cannot." Romans 8:1 is saying there is therefore now no more of that kind of condemnation to them who are in Christ Jesus, who walk no longer after the death nature, the flesh, but after the Spirit.

For the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus set me free from the law of sin and death. What the law could not do because it was weak through the death nature, Jesus Christ Himself came in the likeness of sinful flesh and, by sacrifice for sin, condemned all that sin in the flesh.

You had better go get the whole series on the born-again trail, don't you think?

So the law of the Spirit of life in Christ Jesus - what law is that? The law of the Spirit of life.

What was the Spirit of life? It was the first human spirit to be born on this planet spiritually alive in four thousand years. Four thousand. And the law that emanated from it was a nature free from sin.

So that law took the law that emanated from my death nature, which was sin, replaced it with itself, and set me free.

With that behind you, understanding and intellect are not enough when you are at the mercy of them. The analytical mind is a great servant when it is brought under subjection to the Holy Spirit, the Teacher. So there is nothing wrong with having a lot of knowledge. The question is: who is managing it? Who is teaching it?

Hallelujah, Jesus.

When we get to Romans 8, there is no more of that kind of condemnation. There is no death nature to go to war with your mind and drag you out of keeping the Ten Commandments because you are incapable of it.

Do you have to sin? No, you do not. You know what I found out about that nature? The devil will fight you so hard until he cannot make you take the last step. It seems like that last step is sometimes further than you are. But when you hold out for another step, you will find out you did not have to do it.

You will find out you did not have to sin. Usually you are holding out just a little beyond yourself. It does not matter how you get grace. Your safest long run is knowing it. Hallelujah.

With those things in mind, here we go again.

Are you ready? Hallelujah. I write big words so I can erase them and put two or three in their place. My delete button is an eraser. Hallelujah.

Sister Mary, one of the most frightening accounts in the whole New Testament is what happened to Ananias and Sapphira in the way they died. What makes this so scary is that you and I know of ministries guilty of exactly the same thing, yet they seem to have suffered no particular judgment for their actions.

And if that is not enough, sometimes we think only preachers are accountable enough to be judged that way. Yet Ananias and Sapphira were not exactly preachers, but part of the congregation itself.

In fact, the verses that carry the account of what happened to Ananias and Sapphira are probably one of the worst nightmares for those who love to teach the books of the Bible verse by verse. And for those who love to teach the Bible by subjects, Ananias and Sapphira is a subject often avoided.

So let us take a look at these controversial verses for a moment, the account of what happened.

Of course, I can skip that this time. I have read it three different times. You know what it says, don't you? Read it later.

Like most preachers, Mary, I have an excellent set of Greek books to access the original language. Unfortunately, sometimes the Greek tells the story just as generically as the King James and gives no particular insight as to why judgment would come on Ananias and Sapphira so severely, and over something most preachers would esteem trivial or insignificant, such as lying.

Most commentators console themselves with words like "special act of God," not knowing how to reconcile what happened to Ananias and Sapphira with the morals of the modern-day church. The general conclusion of most commentaries is that they were set forth as some kind of special example, a sort of one-time judgment to strike fear into the hearts of the early church and warn those who would follow.

But if that is the case, Mary, what have we learned? Greed among ministers seems to be at an all-time high. Among a growing number of preachers who represent the gospel, they seem to think the sheep's whole lives rise and fall according to what they are sowing into their ministries. Many times it is quite evident that those same ministries' primary goal is not the gospel, but the pleasures of this life.

I would have screamed over that one years ago.

So, Mary, what happened to Ananias and Sapphira? Was this just a one-time act of God or not? And if God is no respecter of persons, why are there seemingly no consequences for those greedy preachers who were supposed to have learned their lesson from Ananias and Sapphira's judgment?

Can you tell me, Brother Roberson?

Yes, I can. But first let me settle one issue here. A question often asked is, "Did Ananias and Sapphira make it to heaven?" The answer most emphatically is yes.

Now here is the transition. Please go with me to 1 Corinthians 3:9-17, where the apostle Paul was dealing with our reward, the basis for our reward, the least we can get into heaven with, and at what point we can lose our salvation.

That is it for now. Hallelujah, Jesus.

All right, let us take the book of Acts this time and go over to the second chapter. This is when Peter had just finished his message on the day of Pentecost, and three thousand Jews were born again and baptized.

In Acts 2:41, let us pick out a few verses as we go down through here:

Then they that gladly received his word were baptized: and the same day there were added unto them about three thousand souls.

And they continued stedfastly in the apostles' doctrine and fellowship, and in breaking of bread, and in prayers.

And fear came upon every soul: and many wonders and signs were done by the apostles.

And all that believed were together, and had all things common;

And sold their possessions and goods, and parted them to all men, as every man had need.

And they, continuing daily with one accord in the temple, and breaking bread from house to house, did eat their meat with gladness and singleness of heart,

Praising God, and having favour with all the people. And the Lord added to the church daily such as should be saved.

Three thousand plus.

Then Peter and John, in Acts 3:1, went up together into the temple at the hour of prayer, being the ninth hour. A man who was lame from his mother's womb - and later you find out he was above forty years old - was begging alms. You have heard preachers mention this enough. He went running, leaping, jumping, and praising God.

Peter followed that with another tremendous message. This time, five thousand Jews were born again and came in.

So let us go over again. These five thousand came in. Let us go this time to Acts 4:32:

And the multitude of them that believed were of one heart and of one soul: neither said any of them that ought of the things which he possessed was his own; but they had all things common.

And with great power gave the apostles witness of the resurrection of the Lord Jesus: and great grace was upon them all.

Neither was there any among them that lacked: for as many as were possessors of lands or houses sold them, and brought the prices of the things that were sold,

And laid them down at the apostles' feet: and distribution was made unto every man according as he had need.

And Joses, who by the apostles was surnamed Barnabas, which is, being interpreted, The son of consolation, a Levite, and of the country of Cyprus,

Having land, sold it, and brought the money, and laid it at the apostles' feet.

Then, of course, what we have read three or four times comes in the next chapter. After mentioning Joses, he mentions the judgment that fell on Ananias and Sapphira for conspiring to hold back a portion of the sale of the land.

Peter explained to him, "While it was yours, it was yours to do what you wanted. Why did you lie in your heart to the Holy Spirit?"

Separately, both of them fell down dead. They buried the husband first, then carried her out and buried her later. We know that was a severe judgment. It was instantaneous. It was scary.

I was talking to somebody, and they said, "What is God showing you?"

I said, "Right now? Just the latest?"

"Yes."

I said, "Well, He is showing me about Ananias and Sapphira."

So I thought, I am just going to start testing this. I said, "What do you know about them?"

He said, "Oh, I know that the glory was so strong that sin could not enter."

I said, "Well, that is good, just so it does not kill sinners."

"What else?"

"God set it as a one-time example."

See, that is what your commentaries basically say. They do not know what to do with it.

Thank God for the Holy Spirit, who has come alongside and indwelt us and will pray as many mysteries as we will allow. You are the one who has to turn the water off. Have you ever noticed? He will pray a lot longer than you can. You fall off of Him, and the next thing you know, you are waking up.

I can just see God going, "Hey, I did not finish the prayer."

Then you wake up praying in tongues. How many have ever woken up praying in tongues? See there? You were too short with your prescribed time.

Most commentaries say that because you cannot reconcile the morals of the modern-day church with such a judgment as came on Ananias and Sapphira.

But the reason I read the part about them considering nothing their own is because they were of one heart, one mind, one soul, one accord. They sold their possessions and brought them in. There was great grace and joy in the camp.

We have been talking about what came to fullness. What came to fullness here was the workings of miracles. My first glance at how that joy made me feel came in a season when it was on me to that degree. Each day I would wake up and just have to tell somebody, "It is still here. It is still here."

It was like the fight of faith was taken care of because everything about you entered into a celebration. You were not celebrating to try to get there where it is yours. You were celebrating truly because it already was.

Finally, He gave me a little example I could explain it with. It had to be this kind of unity and joy, because when that was on me in its fullness, I had no need. I had none.

I do not know how many times I have been promised a million dollars. "My ship is coming in, and I tell you what, the first thing I am going to do..." I have even been given dates from time to time on a calendar. Dates would come and go.

When you are young, you know how disappointing that is. You know what I quit doing after about four times? I quit spending.

You say, "Well, that is not faith."

Maybe not, but I still had to pay the debt.

I had some pretty good joy when the first ones told me, because I thought, "Hey, they are good people." Well, who knows why? Once you get some money, you talk about a scourge that takes over. You just sit there and look at a million dollars for a while, and after a while it will explain to you what it can do for you.

"Yes, but what could you do with two million?"

It is really strong. Good land.

Anyway, none of it ever made it to the bank. I think the biggest single gift I have received from a person at one time was fifty thousand dollars, which is - boy, man, that is a lot of money. Anyway, pay two or three stations' bills and it is not a lot of money.

The difference between the kind of joy I had been experiencing and happiness and faith is this: someone promises you, "I am going to give you this," and you have this little party and everything. But then somebody actually puts it in the bank. How are you going to feel then?

You feel the power. "My God, I can command this. I can command that." You feel the power. You do not have the lack. You are in the celebration. "What can I do now?" You feel powerful. "Boss is not going to tell me off anymore. I can leave."

You have that power and joy. You can get drunk on it.

That joy visited me just before I went through the biggest trial of my whole life. It visited me for a month. It was incredible. That was where the celebration was. I felt exceeding joy and power and peace from knowing that I was there.

Did you have it in the bank?

No, but it might as well have been.

Reason number one: Ananias and Sapphira were not sitting under a few preachers who were half sold out to the world themselves and did not know anything. They were not sitting under preachers who did not walk in love or power. They were under the twelve who had been trained by Jesus Himself for three and a half years and had heard every teaching and every parable.

So when they went against what they knew, they went against the fullness - the very fullness that love and unity can become. They had been taught that and went exactly the opposite. It was not a greedy, haphazard, full-of-holes message they were learning under. It was the best.

People after their judgment - good land. Let us look at those miracles just one more time. Skip down to Acts 5:12:

And by the hands of the apostles were many signs and wonders wrought among the people; and they were all with one accord in Solomon's porch.

And of the rest durst no man join himself to them: but the people magnified them.

I love King James: "durst no man."

And believers were the more added to the Lord, multitudes both of men and women.

Now this group is swelling. We were at eight thousand. They were being added daily, ten thousand from house to house, and now we are at multitudes. We do not know how many joined themselves to this group.

Insomuch that they brought forth the sick into the streets, and laid them on beds and couches, that at the least the shadow of Peter passing by might overshadow some of them.

There came also a multitude out of the cities round about unto Jerusalem, bringing sick folks, and them which were vexed with unclean spirits: and they were healed every one.

Notice that: unclean spirits. How about just replacing that with "perverted"?

Now, just in case you have heard that and you do not know anybody who got delivered, I can bring you to a multitude who did. How many know that in the past, before I even assimilated this out to this degree, I said that after the season of worship and the weeping, I saw an anointing begin to cooperate in the revival that is coming where people like this were getting set free instantly? Instantly.

What do you think unclean spirits are?

Look at the results. A multitude came out of the cities round about Jerusalem, bringing sick people and those vexed with unclean spirits, and they were healed. Half of them? Okay, three quarters? Okay, I will settle for nine tenths. Anybody? Nine tenths?

No. Every one. He did not say "all" like the crowd. He brought it down singularly: every one. Not one was left out.

When is the last time you saw that? All the sick, all the lame, all the blind. When is the last time you saw the whole crowd get up and walk off free? Have you ever?

Maybe you heard some scattered account. I have listened to some in foreign countries, and they talk about sensationalism. Anyway, we will not get into that.

Now we have a couple of mantles in fullness here. One is that love and joy and unity, so much so that they went past servant. I mean, they made themselves slaves. This was it for them.

Later, when the twelve apostles were arrested, they got out supernaturally. What I was shooting for was when the apostle Paul came with persecution. He was hailing Christians out and locking them up, and everybody fled except for the apostles. They stayed in Jerusalem. The believers were set free to the cities round about, and they began to minister the gospel, such as Philip in Samaria.

Two mantles reached fullness. One was that love, joy, and unity. I have not seen anything like that. I have seen cults with consequences. They own your whole life and death, and there is nothing free about it. These people did not have their possessions taken by force. They ran them up there themselves. The apostles did not preach for them to do it. This was an attribute of the new nature in manifestation.

The second mantle was miracles. Two absolute mantles were at fullness, and Ananias and Sapphira did what they did in the face of all of this.

A third mantle was at fullness, because God has no respect of persons. This is the part we have not understood. One mantle was love. Two was miracles and deliverances. The third mantle was instantaneous judgment.

We looked at the judgment of Alexander and Hymenaeus, because they began to corrupt the foundation and speak blasphemy against the truth. They were getting into law, genealogies, basing salvation on it, and greed. Paul turned them over to Satan that they might learn not to blaspheme.

But this judgment in Peter's hands took place instantly.

Did Ananias and Sapphira go to heaven? As we said, yes, they did. We took a brief fifteen minutes to prove it. Yes, they did go to heaven. We broke down what I was talking about: salvation, your reward, the least you can get into heaven with, and at what point you can begin to lose your salvation. That is the next part I am going to write on in the letter, just to affirm where Ananias and Sapphira went.

That was an instantaneous judgment. The other one, Alexander and Hymenaeus, happened when they began to be destroyed in hopes they would turn back, because they were losing their salvation.

The only other instantaneous judgment done at the hands of one of the apostles was Paul on his first missionary journey to Cyprus, an island about 150 miles off the coast from Antioch. There were two cities there he preached in, and one was Paphos. There he rendered an instantaneous judgment that sealed an entire revival.

People will say, "That was a one-time event for us to follow, to learn our lesson."

How do you learn a lesson if there are no consequences?

Through the Dark Ages there was no healing. Why? Because God could not find anybody He could use to heal with. People suffered, even though there was a form of gospel, and most of it was not true. He could not heal because healing was not present. He could not find anything to do it with.

The only reason there are not men of God on the scene judging like that is because He does not have any yet He can use to do it with. It seems that some of the requirements are the fullness of the mantles, and not only that, but a mercy in these men that rejoices against the very judgment they have to render.

Not some holy war that is going to exalt you. It has nothing to do with that.

Hallelujah.

Is it going to come back? You know it is.

As I said last time, would it not have been better if the apostle Paul had been here and dealt with Carlton rather than letting him go on with thousands and thousands of people beginning to believe they are okay without being born again? Wouldn't it? Wouldn't you like Paul to be here? He could have prevented all that mess as soon as he ran into it.

Can you believe that those acts of judgment have as much to do with the love of God as anything does? More love would be displayed if he were stopped than if he were allowed to go on destroying at the level he is.

Let us go look at this Cyprus judgment, shall we? Hallelujah.

Is anybody having a good time? I am.

Somebody took the book of Acts out of here. How about chapter 13? Verse 4:

So they, being sent forth by the Holy Ghost, departed unto Seleucia; and from thence they sailed to Cyprus.

Cyprus is about 150 miles out to sea.

And when they were at Salamis, they preached the word of God in the synagogues of the Jews: and they had also John to their minister.

Salamis was the first town or city in Cyprus after they put in. Then they went about seventy-five miles more to the other end of Cyprus, up the coast to Paphos.

And when they had gone through the isle unto Paphos, they found a certain sorcerer, a false prophet, a Jew, whose name was Bar-Jesus:

Which was with the deputy of the country, Sergius Paulus, a prudent man; who called for Barnabas and Saul, and desired to hear the word of God.

But Elymas the sorcerer (for so is his name by interpretation) withstood them, seeking to turn away the deputy from the faith.

Bar-Jesus had graduated. Now he has this name, Elymas. Elymas must be bad, kind of like Lucifer or something.

Then Saul, (who also is called Paul,) filled with the Holy Ghost, set his eyes on him,

And said, O full of all subtilty and all mischief, thou child of the devil, thou enemy of all righteousness, wilt thou not cease to pervert the right ways of the Lord?

And now, behold, the hand of the Lord is upon thee, and thou shalt be blind, not seeing the sun for a season.

And immediately there fell on him a mist and a darkness; and he went about seeking some to lead him by the hand.

Then the deputy, when he saw what was done, believed, being astonished at the doctrine of the Lord.

Hallelujah.

Boy, I am getting excited about this revival that is coming. Is anybody else?

He has called us to a revival of doctrine and soundness and signs and wonders and judgment.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

Now that is one call that, whatever He has called me to be, I would gladly leave that one off. He has already scared about three or four Sundays out of me. When He took me on a little trip, He went on and judged a couple of things. But I had this definite sense inside that He needed me to be there.

So I knew it was a teaching trip, and I knew it was something He wanted to get done. That was when I first began to understand judgment just a little bit, still hoping that it would not ever really fall in my life.

Let us go over to 1 Corinthians while we still have a couple of minutes. Chapter 5, verse 1. I just want to pick on one thing here for a few minutes.

This is the judgment of the man who had his father's wife. He was also turned over to Satan for the destruction of the flesh, but Paul explains it further. It was because God loved him, in hopes that his spirit would be saved in the day of the Lord.

What do you think happened to him? I think some dreaded disease came on him or something because he was out in the devil's territory, and he ended up turning his face back to God, repenting, and then probably dying. But whether he died or not is neither here nor there to me. The fact is, Paul said this would result in his spirit being saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.

So what would you rather be? A guy who was not turned over and went to hell, or a guy who was turned over and went to heaven, since you would already have been there for a couple thousand years?

Turn me over. I would rather be going to heaven. I would rather be in heaven.

But look what Paul needed to do this with. Starting with the first verse:

It is reported commonly that there is fornication among you, and such fornication as is not so much as named among the Gentiles, that one should have his father's wife.

I am just hoping it was the stepmother. That would be really, really bad. You could not even rank sinners that would have a better church than that.

The difference between fornication and adultery is plain. Adultery is an adulterated act. Fornication is the same, an adulterated act, but somebody has been betrayed. That is why He said divorce was not allowed except for fornication. That is when a partner is betrayed.

So there was fornication commonly reported among them. There was danger of it establishing itself as leaven or as a foundational truth in their doctrine that this was okay. That is why Paul was so disciplined with it.

And ye are puffed up, and have not rather mourned, that he that hath done this deed might be taken away from among you.

For I verily, as absent in body, but present in spirit, have judged already, as though I were present, concerning him that hath so done this deed.

Notice this. He says, "I am absent in body, but present in spirit." That is a little s, so he is talking about his human spirit.

I have heard people say, "See, Paul traveled there."

No, he did not. What he did do is discern the situation. He discerned it. Why do you think he said, "I am there in spirit"? Because one more time, if God is going to operate in that judgment, He needs to find authority. He needs to find somebody He can do it through.

That is the only reason it is not flowing now. But when this big outpouring comes - trust me, because media is going to have a revival - you are going to see people leading people down the wrong paths receive things at the hands of the men of God that will strike salvational kind of fear into people.

And it will all be because He loves you. Do you understand that? He loves you.

When Paul said he was present in spirit, he did not take a little trip over there. What he was saying was, "I have discerned this, so you have the authority I have. Use it to turn this person over now."

Did they? Yes, they did. Some people say he repented. Some say he did not. I have not found out yet. Why? Because it did not bother me.

Paul said:

In the name of our Lord Jesus Christ, when ye are gathered together, and my spirit, with the power of our Lord Jesus Christ,

To deliver such an one unto Satan for the destruction of the flesh, that the spirit may be saved in the day of the Lord Jesus.

Your glorying is not good. Know ye not that a little leaven leaveneth the whole lump?

Purge out therefore the old leaven, that ye may be a new lump.

We already explained that.

Here is a good one on judgment. How about 1 Corinthians 6:3?

Know ye not that we shall judge angels? how much more things that pertain to this life?

So what are you going to be doing at the judgment bar with Jesus Christ when they bring all these rogue angels up and you get to pronounce their wrong or right?

What does he mean here? What angels are you going to judge? That is interesting, is it not?

Should we go over and look at a little more?

Let us go to the eleventh chapter. Of course, at the end of it, in verse 31, he said:

For if we would judge ourselves, we should not be judged.

And when we are judged, we are corrected and chastened by God, so that we should not be condemned to die under the same things the world does.

But let us go back to the first part of this chapter and just throw something on you here. How about verse 1? Then I will stop. I have to.

Be ye followers of me, even as I also am of Christ.

Now I praise you, brethren, that ye remember me in all things, and keep the ordinances, as I delivered them to you.

But I would have you know, that the head of every man is Christ; and the head of the woman is the man; and the head of Christ is God.

Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonoureth his head.

So much for a hat, I guess.

But every woman that prayeth or prophesieth with her head uncovered dishonoureth her head: for that is even all one as if she were shaven.

For if the woman be not covered, let her also be shorn: but if it be a shame for a woman to be shorn or shaven, let her be covered.

Well, that is interesting. Do you understand that?

Of course. But evidently, you women do not listen. Where is your hat?

We are okay. We are not wearing a hat covering. What happened? You just do not care what it means?

Oh, well. I reckon we will get to it next Sunday.